

Career & Goal Planning

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Date filled in: _____

Horizon: _____ to _____

A working worksheet — write in it, cross things out, be honest rather than impressive.

1 THE HOURS I ACTUALLY HAVE

Not the ones I wish I had

List every standing commitment for a normal week this semester — classes, the costume shop, shoots, church, commute, sleep, seeing people you love. Add the hours up before you plan anything. The number at the bottom is the truth you have to build on.

[illegible]

2 MY THREE LANES, TOLD STRAIGHT

Costume · Film & Writing · Photo & Other. Fill a column for each. A lane can be excellent and still be the wrong one to push this year — that is what the last row is for.

	COSTUME	FILM & WRITING	PHOTO / OTHER
What I'm known for <i>now</i>			
Strongest piece of proof I have			
What I want to be known for by 2029			
The weakest link between here and there			
Does it pay yet? Could it?			
Does it feed me or drain me?			
This year: <i>grow / bold / pause</i>			

3 WHAT IS NOT UP FOR NEGOTIATION

Money I must earn, hours I cannot exceed, people and practices I will not sacrifice, health limits. Everything else in this worksheet has to fit around these.

4 THE LADDER

Write the far one first, then work down. Each rung should make the one above it more likely.

Five years out — autumn 2031

Where do I live? What does a good Tuesday look like? What am I making, and who am I making it with? What pays for it?

Two years out — autumn 2028, roughly eighteen months after graduation

Three sentences. What is my title, or the honest description of what I do? What is on my reel or in my book? Who knows my name?

Graduation — May 2027. What has to be TRUE by then?

Portfolio, credits, relationships, savings, a place to live, a first job or the runway to look for one. Be specific enough to check off.

WHAT MUST BE TRUE BY MAY 2027	WHY IT MATTERS	TRUE YET? WHAT IS MISSING

This academic year — September 2026 to May 2027

No more than three goals. If everything is a goal, nothing is. Add how you will know each one is DONE, not "worked on."

GOAL FOR THE YEAR	DONE LOOKS LIKE...	FIRST MOVE	BY WHEN

This semester — through December 2026

WHAT I WILL FINISH THIS SEMESTER	WHICH YEAR-GOAL IT SERVES	DEADLINE

This month

This week — three things, no more

If the week goes sideways, which ONE of these still happens?

Pick the goal that scares you most and walk it backwards

WORKING BACKWARDS	WHAT MUST ALREADY BE DONE	WHO OR WHAT I NEED FOR IT
The goal itself		
One month before		
Three months before		
Six months before		
The very next step		

Nothing happens without submitting, applying, or asking. Keep this page fed.

[illegible]

The stuff that speaks when you are not in the room

3 / 6

10 THE WEEK I WANT

Block the non-negotiables first, then the deep work, then the rest

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Morning							
Midday							
Afternoon							
Evening							

What refills me (and how often do I actually do it?)

What drains me fastest — and what is the early warning sign that I am running on empty?

11 SKILLS TO BUILD

Pick few. A half-learned skill is a hobby; a finished one is a credit.

SKILL OR CRAFT	WHY IT MATTERS TO THE GOAL	HOW I LEARN IT (CLASS, SHOP, PROJECT, PERSON)	COST	BY WHEN

12 HOW I DECIDE

Write the filter now, while nothing is at stake, so you can use it when something is

I say YES when...

I say NO when...

My automatic no-s this year — the things I will stop being talked into:

The last three things I said yes to. Would the filter above have let them through? Should it have?

13 THE HONEST QUESTIONS

If I could only work in ONE lane for the next twelve months, which would I pick — and what does that tell me?

What am I doing mostly because someone would be disappointed if I stopped?

What am I afraid of? Underneath that, what am I actually afraid of?

What is actually true / what I would do about it

The worksheet is worthless without this part

WHO KNOWS I SAID SO

Ten minutes, first of the month. Same five questions.

THE ONE THING NEXT MONTH

Park it here rather than carrying it around